



DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC SAFETY GEORGIA STATE PATROL

PURSUIT CRITIQUE

TROOPER NAME – TFC Jamie Wilson #548

Work Assignment: Troop/Division - A; Post/Unit – 28 - Jasper

INCIDENT REPORT # DPS00152295

Related Crash Reports: C000944175 ; C000944176 ; C000944177

P.I.T. Involved: No

S.C.R.T. Involved: No

Special Investigations Unit Involved: No

Use of Force Involved: No

MEETING

1. Document the date, time and location of the pursuit critique meeting with the involved trooper.

Date: 3/22/2024

Time: 1315 hours

Location: Conference call

2. List all personnel present at the meeting by name and rank. Include the trooper, an NCO in whose territory the pursuit was terminated, and the trooper's immediate supervisor.

Personnel present: Captain Shawn Prather #11, SFC Kevin Evans #312 and TFC Jamie Wilson #548.

INITIATION

1. Provide the date and time the trooper became involved in the pursuit.

Date: 03/05/2024

Time: 2331 hours

2. Explain the circumstances that led to the trooper's involvement in the pursuit.

The Pickens County Sheriff's Office conducted a felony stop on a suspect that was wanted by the U.S. Marshalls Service. The suspect fled from the traffic stop, initiating a pursuit with the Deputies. Once the pursuit initiated, the Pickens County Sheriff's Office requested the assistance of the Georgia State Patrol. TFC Wilson received the request, responded and later entered the pursuit.

3. If trooper's involvement was the result of a request from another agency, provide details regarding the request.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TFC Wilson overheard over Pickens County radio frequency Sgt. Pankey communicate the request to notify GSP and see if anyone was in the area. TFC Wilson heard this request and notified the Troop A Communications Center.

4. List the number and identity of other agencies and officers involved in the pursuit.

☐ N/A

If needed, list: There were three Pickens County Deputies involved in the pursuit and they were identified as: Sergeant Evan Pankey, Deputy Robert Johnston and Deputy Mark Williams.

5. If other occupants were in the patrol vehicle, identify them and state their reason for being in the vehicle.

☒ N/A

If Yes, list:

6. Did the trooper take appropriate safety precautions?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper eliminate distractions such as FM radio noise?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

COMMUNICATION

1. If the reporting trooper initiated the pursuit by means of observing a violation and attempting a traffic stop, explain the communication that took place between the trooper and the CEO.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

2. Did the trooper relay pertinent information to the CEO including:

- Location and direction of travel.
- Description of the pursued vehicle.
- Number and description of occupants.
- Information regarding the use of firearms, threat of force, or other hazard.
- Options for terminating the pursuit.
- Observed danger to public safety.
- Any need for assistance.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Explain any communication that took place between the CEO and other law enforcement agencies or officers in the area.

☐ N/A Explain: Once TFC Wilson entered the pursuit, the Troop A Communications Center cleared the radio for emergency traffic before conducting a broadcast of the pursuit to all Troop A Troopers.

4. If the reporting trooper became involved in the pursuit at the request of another agency, explain any communication that took place between the trooper and another officer of the requesting agency. Give details of communication between the CEO and the requesting agency regarding the location, direction of travel, nature of the offense, any pending warrants, and details of erratic driving behavior illustrating the potential danger to the public if the suspect is not immediately apprehended.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: TFC Wilson communicated over the Pickens County radio frequency that he was on Camp Road at GA 5 as he was traveling to assist. No other communications occurred between agencies.

5. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

6. At the conclusion of the pursuit, did the trooper advise the CEO immediately, so other units would be familiar with the location to offer assistance, or slow in an effort to reduce the likelihood of further risk of injury to either a trooper or a member of the general public?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

7. Discuss any needed areas of improvement with the CEO.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

PURSUIT

1. Describe the route the pursuit traveled, its duration and distance.

Describe: TFC Wilson entered the pursuit on GA 5 southbound near Cornett Lane. The suspect was traveling south on GA 5 in the northbound lane. The pursuit continued until the suspect turned left onto GA 108. The pursuit traveled a short distance on GA 108 eastbound and terminated. TFC Wilson was in the pursuit for approximately 1 minute, 30 seconds, and traveled a total distance of approximately 2.1 miles.

2. Were the trooper's actions during the pursuit objectively reasonable?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. If the pursuit traveled into another post's territory, explain whether the initiating trooper yielded to a trooper whose territory the pursuit was in.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

4. If the initiating trooper yielded the primary position to another unit, explain whether he proceeded to the termination point of the pursuit to provide guidance and information for the arrest of the violator.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

5. Explain if there were any factors during the pursuit that indicated the possible commission of a felony.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: The violator's actions during the pursuit support a felony charge of fleeing and attempting to elude.

6. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper practice commentator driving?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

8. Did the trooper remain calm and professional during the pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

DRIVING SKILLS

1. Did the trooper use due caution when operating his vehicle during the pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

2. Were the driving skills/techniques initiated appropriately?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during the pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

4. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during termination?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

5. Did the trooper appear to experience adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or any other internal/external factors?

☐ No If Yes, explain: TFC Wilson stated that he experienced an adrenalin rush.

6. Did the trooper get into the danger zone due to adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or other factors?

☒ No If Yes, explain:

EQUIPMENT

1. Were the blue lights and siren in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

2. If the patrol car was equipped with wig-wag headlights, were they in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. Was the in-car camera working properly?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

4. Was the trooper's microphone working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

TERMINATION

1. Did the trooper continue the pursuit to a conclusion? If not, explain the reasons.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Was there a good probability of the suspect's arrest at a later time because of positive identification?

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

3. Articulate attempts taken by the trooper to utilize pursuit termination techniques, such as tire deflating devices, roadblocks, P.I.T. maneuver, and trooper discretion.

☒ N/A

Explain:

4. Expound on safety precautions utilized by the trooper during and after the pursuit.

☐ N/A

Explain: TFC Wilson properly operated his patrol car in emergency mode as he responded to the pursuit. TFC Wilson performed well at communicating his observations and properly pursued the suspect when he drove on the wrong side of the roadway for an extended period.

5. Articulate the existing traffic conditions during the pursuit, realizing the conditions may differ at various times during the pursuit.

Explain: The pursuit occurred during daytime hours with clear skies and the roadway surface was dry. The traffic conditions on GA 5 would be described as moderate.

6. Address whether there are any conditions that would create additional danger to the public by continuing the pursuit.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

7. Address whether there were any conditions that necessitated the pursuit being brought to an immediate conclusion and describe the conditions.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

8. Establish whether the violator was an immediate threat to the trooper, the public or themselves.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The violator fled at high speeds, and failed to stop for red traffic signals and drove on the wrong side of the roadway, going against traffic for a great amount of time. The suspect posed a great threat to himself, Troopers and the public.

9. Outline whether the use of deadly force was justified and if so, why it was justified.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

10. Establish whether the method of termination was reasonable based on the facts gathered during the pursuit, and state those facts.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

11. If there were any injuries, state who received them, the type and severity.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The suspect had visible injuries.

12. If there was a fatality, provide basic facts surrounding the circumstances.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

13. Address any damage to vehicles.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The suspect's vehicle was struck in the left side by the front of a Pickens County Sheriff's patrol car. The damage disabled the Pickens County patrol car (Dodge Charger) and the suspect's vehicle received functional damage as he continued to flee. Another Pickens County Deputy then initiated the PIT with his Chevrolet Tahoe. The Tahoe struck the suspect's vehicle in the right side with the left front of the Tahoe. The suspect then traveled off the roadway, striking a road sign before traveling down an embankment and overturning.

TROOPER'S ABILITIES AND EXPERIENCE

1. Prior pursuits (compare if appropriate).

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: This was TFC Wilson's fifth pursuit during his career with the Department.

2. Past use of techniques and high speed driving.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TFC Wilson has received EVOC, Advanced EVOC and the annual Pursuit Liability Training.

ISSUES ADDRESSED

1. Positives.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TFC Wilson properly operated his patrol car in emergency mode as he responded to the pursuit. TFC Wilson performed well at communicating his observations and properly pursued the suspect when he drove on the wrong side of the roadway.

2. Areas for improvement.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TFC Wilson was reminded of the importance of verbally clearing intersection(s) when he doesn't have the right of way during emergency situations.

3. Other considerations.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain: The pursuit was terminated by a Pickens County Deputy when he initiated the PIT.

RESPONSE FROM TROOPER OR SUPERVISOR

1. Allow trooper and supervisor an opportunity to respond or add comments.



N/A

If Yes, explain:

CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

1. Describe any corrective action taken as a result of the trooper's actions during the pursuit.



N/A

If Yes, explain:

Captain Shawn Prather #11
Reviewing Officer

CAPT.  #11

4/15/2024
Date